

Matthew Shorey, LHP, Vanderbilt

2026 Stats: 3.00 ERA/.833 WHIP/6 IP/8 K/2 BB/4 K:BB

6-2, 186

Metrics

FB: 90.7/10.8 IVB/-18.4 HB/-4.32 VAA/5 relH/5.9 ext/12.9 AA/47.9% zone/47.1% usage/2410 rpm

CT: 86.1/7.3 IVB/1.3 HB/-6.4 VAA/14.6 AA/0% zone/2% usage/2490 rpm

SWP: 80.3/1.1 IVB/13.2 HB/-7.38 VAA/8.7 AA/36.4% zone/32.4% usage/2610 rpm

CH: 82.3/-5 IVB/-15.7 HB/-6.69 VAA/7.5 AA/21.1% zone/18.6% usage/1850 rpm

Write-up

A crossfire right-hander with a low three-quarter slot, Matthew Shorey creates uncomfortable angles that make his arsenal play above its raw velocity. His delivery creates deception from both sides of the plate, allowing a riding fastball to play at the top of the zone while a sweeping breaking ball and fading changeup attack laterally. While the sample size is limited, the movement profile is intriguing and the pitch shapes fit together naturally. The next step will be improving command and adding physical strength to hold velocity deeper into outings. Right now, Shorey projects as a strike-throwing developmental starter with a chance to fit in the back of a rotation, though the deception and crossfire angle also provide a solid bullpen floor if the command stalls.

The FB is the foundation of the arsenal. Sitting around 91 mph, it carries well through the top of the zone with over 18 inches of horizontal vertical break and a flat -4.32 VAA. Despite below-average velocity, the release characteristics and crossfire angle allow the pitch to get on hitters quicker than expected, producing a 30% whiff rate while generating plenty of swings above the belt. Shorey consistently worked the fastball to the upper third against both handednesses, allowing the carry to play at its best. The pitch lacks premium velocity, leaving little margin for mistakes over the heart of the plate, but the shape is comfortably above average and gives him a legitimate foundation. 50/55 pitch
The CT was used sparingly, making it difficult to fully evaluate, but the movement profile is intriguing. Sitting in the mid-80s with short glove-side action and additional ride, it projects as a bridge between

the fastball and sweeper rather than a true swing-and-miss pitch. The velocity separation is minimal, allowing it to play more as a contact-management offering that can steal strikes against left-handed hitters and keep righties from sitting on the fastball. As Shorey gains confidence and increases usage, the cutter could develop into a useful complementary weapon. 40/45 pitch

The SWP flashes the best pure movement in the arsenal. At roughly 80 mph, it features well above-average sweep with enough depth to miss barrels against right-handed hitters. Shorey showed feel for landing it around the zone while also burying it beneath the strike zone as a chase pitch. The crossfire delivery enhances the visual angle, making the ball appear to start behind right-handed hitters before sweeping back across the plate. The pitch would benefit from another tick or two of velocity, but the shape alone gives it legitimate bat-missing upside and projects as his primary breaking ball moving forward. 50/55 pitch

The CH is an intriguing fourth offering that plays well off the fastball. Thrown with excellent velocity separation, the pitch features heavy fade and enough depth to generate uncomfortable swing decisions from opposite-handed hitters. Shorey consistently located it beneath the zone, allowing hitters to chase the late movement rather than forcing it into the strike zone. The limited usage leaves room for growth, but the movement profile fits naturally with the rest of the arsenal and gives him a legitimate weapon against left-handed hitters. Increasing confidence in the pitch would further round out the repertoire and help maintain starter projection. 45/50 pitch